Andrew Palacios Jr.

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Summary

Lead Software Engineer and Cal Poly Pomona Computer Science graduate (Magna Cum Laude) with experience in full-stack web and mobile development and software education, including coaching students to award-winning results.

Work Experience

Apulza (Startup) (apulza-ai.com) Jun 2026 - Present

Lead Software Engineer Sep 2026 - Present

- Lead engineering across mobile, backend, and web as Apulza prepares for beta, remaining the only engineer on the mobile product; help interview candidates, plan sprints, and manage interns.
- Designed and built My Tutor, a Socratic AI tutoring module (FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Next.js, Groq), including its data model, hint ladder, assignment-content classifier, student and counselor dashboards, and test suite.
- Led beta readiness work: invite-only sign-up, account deletion, plan limits, and deployment setup.

Software Engineer Intern Jun 2026 - Aug 2026

- Built Apulza's cross-platform mobile app from the ground up as its only engineer (Expo/React Native, TypeScript), including onboarding, course/assignment tracking, notifications, and gamification.
- Built AI assignment breakdowns with Groq and a rule-based fallback, plus in-app notifications and encrypted Canvas token storage.
- Extended the FastAPI/PostgreSQL backend and Next.js frontend to support new mobile features.
- Built features under an accessibility-first design framework for ADHD and neurodivergent users, applying cognitive-load and emotional-safety principles to UI and copy.
- Contributed to the public marketing site (React, TypeScript, Vite), with roughly 2,000 unique visitors.

Coding Instructor, Coding Minds Academy, Diamond Bar CA Sep 2023 - Present

- Delivered weekly one-on-one instruction to 12-15 students per semester across Python, Java, OOP, and introductory Machine Learning; led the majority of Python and ML curriculum.
- Achieved a 100% top-3 GameGala placement rate across all students taught, with multiple 1st and 2nd place individual project finishes over two years.

Project Experience

Budgy (github.com/AndrewPal04/BudgetBuddy-Budgy | budget-buddy-budgy.vercel.app)

- Designed and built a full-stack personal budgeting app (React, TypeScript, Supabase) with multi-account tracking, expense categorization, and CSV export, deployed on Vercel.
- Built interactive data visualizations (Recharts) for spending breakdowns and savings growth projections, including configurable interest-rate modeling across accounts.
- Integrated the Groq API to generate personalized financial tips, with form validation (Zod, React Hook Form) and full auth flows (onboarding, password reset, email confirmation) via Supabase.

Campus Connect (github.com/AndrewPal04/CampusConnect)

- Led a three-person CS 4800 team building a campus event app, handling most planning and development.
- Built with React Native (Expo), Node.js, Express, and PostgreSQL, with RSVP, QR tickets, notifications, rule-based recommendations, an admin panel, and a scraper that loads real Cal Poly Pomona events.

UAV Search and Rescue in GPS Denied Areas

- Contributed to design of a dual-drone search and rescue system on NVIDIA Jetson; reviewed ROS2 code.
- Scout drone used ORB-SLAM3 with a ZED stereo camera to map the area and detect targets, sending coordinates over an XBee-to-ROS2 bridge to a delivery drone that planned its path with OMPL and MAVROS.

Skills

Languages: Python, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, Dart, C, C++, SQL
Frameworks & Tools: React, Next.js, React Native (Expo), Flutter, Node.js, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Supabase, Firebase, Cloudflare Workers, Groq API, Docker, GitHub Actions, ROS2, MAVROS, Gazebo, ORB-SLAM3, OMPL, Git, GCP, Linux
Concepts: Full-Stack Development, Distributed Systems, Networking, CI/CD, Automated Testing, OOP

Education

California State Polytechnic University, Pomona Aug 2022 - Aug 2026
B.S. Computer Science | GPA: 3.67 | **Magna Cum Laude** | Dean's List 2023-2026 | President's List 2025-2026
Relevant Coursework: Algorithms, Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Database Systems, Software Engineering